Questions for Dad's Next Check-Up

Fifteen questions for his doctor, his pharmacist and the other professionals he already sees, sorted by who can answer, with room to write what they say.

Dad has a check-up coming, and he's happy for you to come along. Go through this list with him first. It's his appointment: he may want to ask some of these himself, and cross out others.

Bring the questions written down, ask them as they are, and write the answer under each one. This guide doesn't answer them and doesn't say which matters most. The people below know Dad, and a page doesn't.

His doctor

1. Here is what an ordinary week looks like for Dad right now. Is there anything in it you'd like to know more about?

2. Here are the things we've noticed changing, with dates. Which of them, if any, would you like to look at?

3. Which kinds of changes would you want to hear about between visits, and how should we get in touch?

4. When would you like to look again at how he's managing day to day?

5. If we ever notice something about eating, swallowing, continence or skin, would you want to hear about it, or does it go to someone else?

6. Could Dad have a current summary of his health, and any care instructions, in writing?

7. Which of the questions on our list belong with someone else, and with whom?

His pharmacist, or whoever prescribes

1. Here is the list of everything he takes, including over-the-counter medicines, vitamins and supplements. Does it match your records?

2. If we have a question about one of his medications, who should we ask, and who do we ask before anything is changed?

3. Do you have written information about his medicines that he can keep at home?

A therapist or service he already uses, if there is one

1. What do you work on with Dad, and how often do you see him?

2. How does he get up, sit down and get around when he's with you, and does he use anything to help?

3. Is there anything you'd like us to note down between visits and bring to you?

Your care consultant

Meets Dad himself as well as talking with the family, and looks across his everyday life as a whole.

1. Here is what we have on paper about Dad's days. What's missing that you'd want to know?

2. What would you want to hear from Dad himself, and not from us?

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't answer these questions or put them in order of importance. Dad's doctor and the other people who know him do that. And if Dad would rather ask some of them himself, or leave some out, that's his call.

Ready for the next step?

You have your questions, and you know whom each one is for. The care interview gives the answers somewhere to go: it walks through Dad's situation area by area and turns what you know into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Writing questions down before a visit, taking notes during it, keeping one list of everything a person takes and asking for written information about medicines all follow the Family Caregiver Alliance's guide to medications. The other questions come from the Family Care Roadmap's working list for this step, and the grouping by role is ours.

1. Family Caregiver Alliance, Caregiver's Guide to Medications and Aging